How can we access these views? First we turn to the insights of three Indian writers who lived and travelled in China beginning in the early 1980s (there do not seem to be equivalent writings by Chinese travellers except for Hong Mei's *The Farther I Walk, the Closer I Get to Me*, which is only available in Mandarin). Beyond these writings, two academic studies of Indian and Chinese attitudes in the mainstream and social media reveal the extent of racist and jingoistic views, particularly in China. A third source is survey and polling data of Indian attitudes which depict the extent of fear and mistrust towards China, especially after the Doklam confrontation in 2017. Finally, Indian dispositions towards the ethnic Chinese in India and towards China in the wake of Covid-19 show that racism and jingoism are alive and well south of the Himalaya too.

Chinese Perceptions of India: Through Indian Eyes

We can begin to get a sense of more contemporary Chinese views of India through three writers who spent time in China – Vikram Seth, the Indian novelist and poet, Anurag Vishwanath, an Indian scholar who travelled widely in the country as part of her doctoral and postdoctoral studies, and, Reshma Patil, an Indian journalist who reported mostly from the big Chinese cities.

'From Heaven Lake'

In 1981, Vikram Seth, the writer but at the time a doctoral student from Stanford University studying in China, hitchhiked from Xinjiang to Tibet on his way home to India. He records his arduous journey and his encounters with ordinary Chinese people along the way in a candid, affectionate book, *From Heaven Lake: Travels Through Xinjiang and Tibet*.[34] It is a revealing account: the Chinese clap to Bollywood songs, are curious about India, soothe Seth over the 1962 war, and display a cheery ignorance about Indian society. In Turfan, Xinjiang, he is asked to sing an Indian song in front of a